Archiver

A NEW LANGUAGE FOR LIBRARIAN AND ARCHIVIST

The Reading Room

A calm place to retrieve your work.
A dependable place to preserve its history.

One product. Two complementary roles. Warm paper, deep ink, catalog tabs, and an identity built around keeping things findable.

PROPOSED DIRECTION · APP MIGRATION PENDING



Creative reference. Material cues become flat color and precise geometry in the interface.

Two roles in the same collection

The visual language should explain the split already implemented in Archiver.

01

Librarian

Find it. Use it. Return to work.

The compact panel for retrieval from the visible library. Search comes first; the interface stays close to the keyboard.

Surface	480 × 720, bounded to the monitor
Scope	Library; full archive on explicit toggle
Primary action	Enter copies; Ctrl+Enter pastes
Visual rhythm	Compact header, strong selection, one footer

02

Archivist

Browse it. Understand it. Keep it.

The full window for permanent history, provenance, organization, previews, terminal sessions, settings, and recovery.

Surface	1280 × 850 default; 900 × 400 minimum
Scope	Entire archive, including hidden library items
Primary actions	Inspect, copy, insert, organize, restore
Visual rhythm	Sidebar, results, readable detail pane

Permanent archive

Visible library
A changing set of archived items

Clear library → change visibility
Explicit deletion → remove archived content

Archiver stays the app name. Librarian and Archivist stay the window names.

A recognizable home for your history



Archiver

PRIMARY LOCKUP

Three stepped catalog cards suggest a collection. A cut in the front card hints at an A.

The mark connects the library and the archive without making either window a separate brand. The product wordmark uses Instrument Serif; window labels use DM Sans.



App tile



Night / inverse



16–24 px micro

Use with restraint

Keep one tab-width of clear space. Use the primary mark at 32 px and above. Use the two-card micro silhouette below 32 px; verify 16, 20, 24, and 32 px at actual scale.

The SVGs are the editable reference. Rasterize platform icons from them; tray icons use a transparent, single-color mark.

Consistent family Archiver / product Librarian / retrieval Archivist / preservation

Creative exploration translated into clean vector geometry. Optical review required before release.

Warmth through color and typography

Flat surfaces, fine rules, and useful contrast. Texture stays in brand artwork.

Paper	Ink	Spruce	Brass
#F5F1E8	#252B28	#214E44	#73572C

Night paper	Chalk ink	Soft spruce	Soft brass
#191F1C	#EEECE3	#A6C8B5	#D7BB87

Semantic use

Spruce identifies selection, actions, and focus. Brass distinguishes command content. State text and icons distinguish capture, warnings, and failures. Decorative rules use a quieter token than control borders.

Color values and compatibility aliases are supplied in tokens.css. Contrast checks cover text on its intended surface, focus, controls, and selection.

EXISTING FONT FAMILIES, NEW HIERARCHY

Your archive

Instrument Serif · 40/44
Page headings and product wordmark

A useful record of your work.

DM Sans · 14/20 · 400–600
Controls, results, metadata, window names

```
git log --oneline -12
```

Consolas / system mono · 13/20
Commands, paths, exact stored content

4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 24 / 32	Spacing rhythm
6 / 12 px	Control / panel radii

Serif never carries dense data. Metadata is 12 px minimum; Librarian footer uses 11 px. Avoid letter-spaced microcopy inside results.

A small, useful reading desk

Search is the anchor. The selected record has a clear edge and a calm spruce surface.

01 **A quiet window signature**

The Archiver mark and “Librarian” identify the panel. No artwork competes with retrieval.

02 **Scope remains explicit**

Library is the default. Archive mode visibly changes the search label and scope tab.

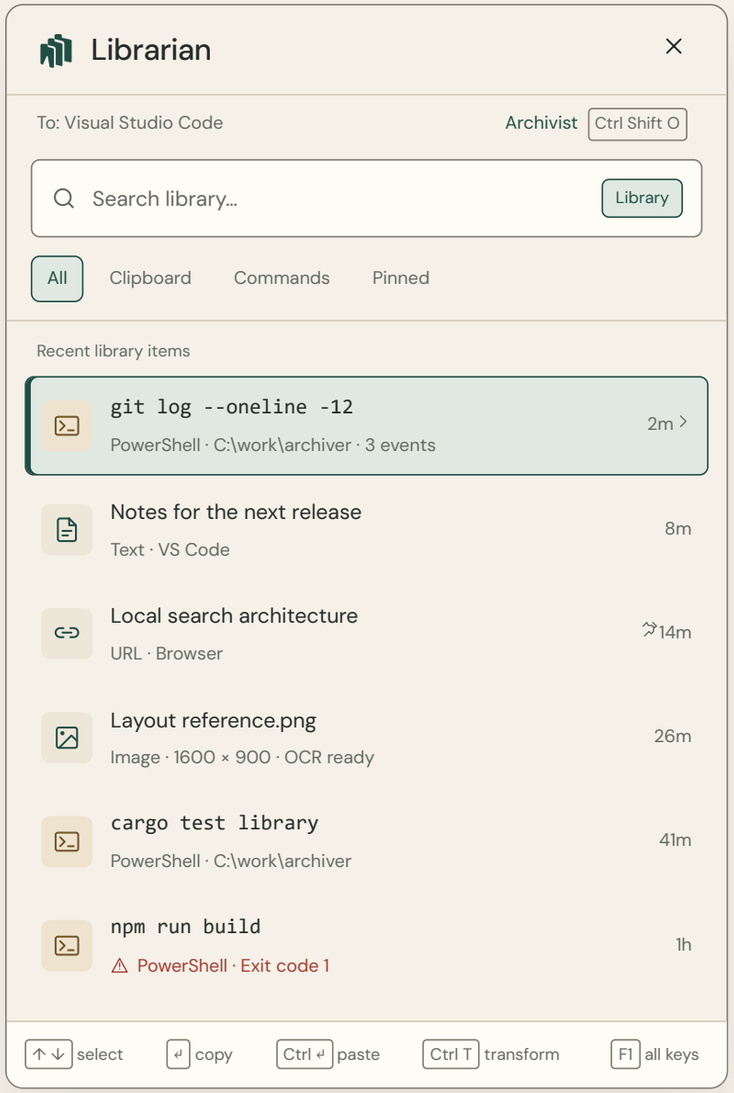
03 **Rows carry real context**

Source, age, command directory, repeat count, and failure state stay legible.

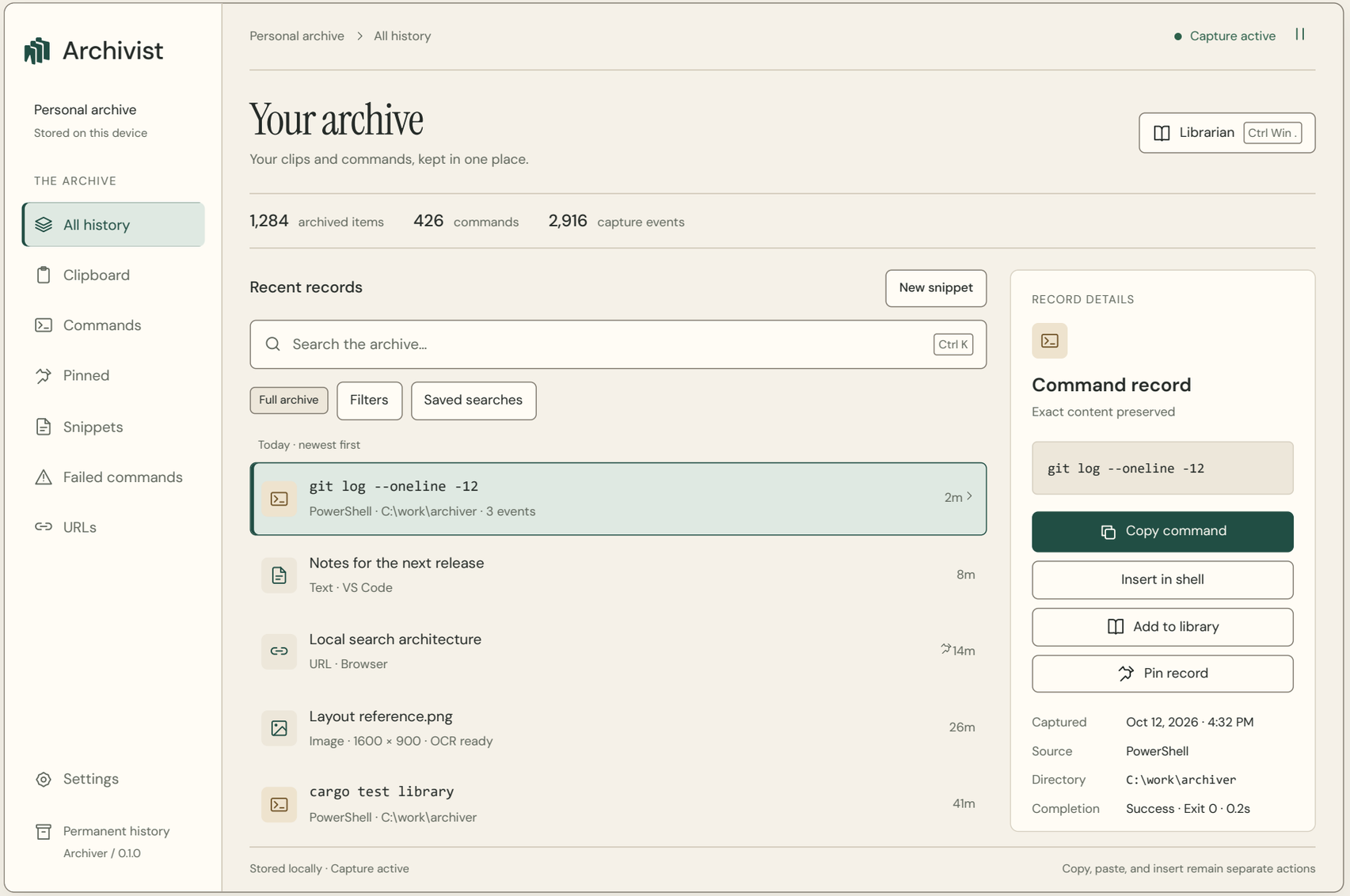
04 **One useful footer**

Keep current copy, paste, transform, navigation, and F1 behavior.

Interactive HTML offers sample scope and state controls.
480 × 720 frame shown at 82%.



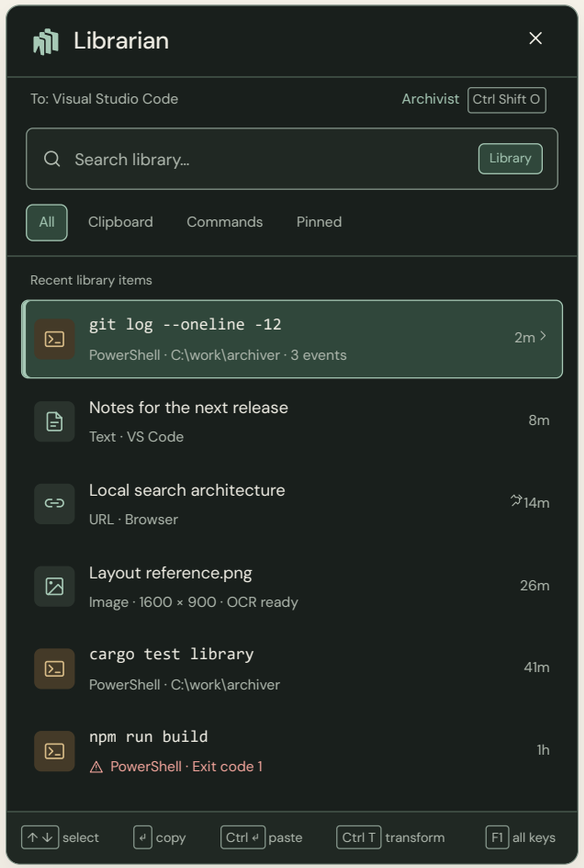
A clear workspace for the whole record

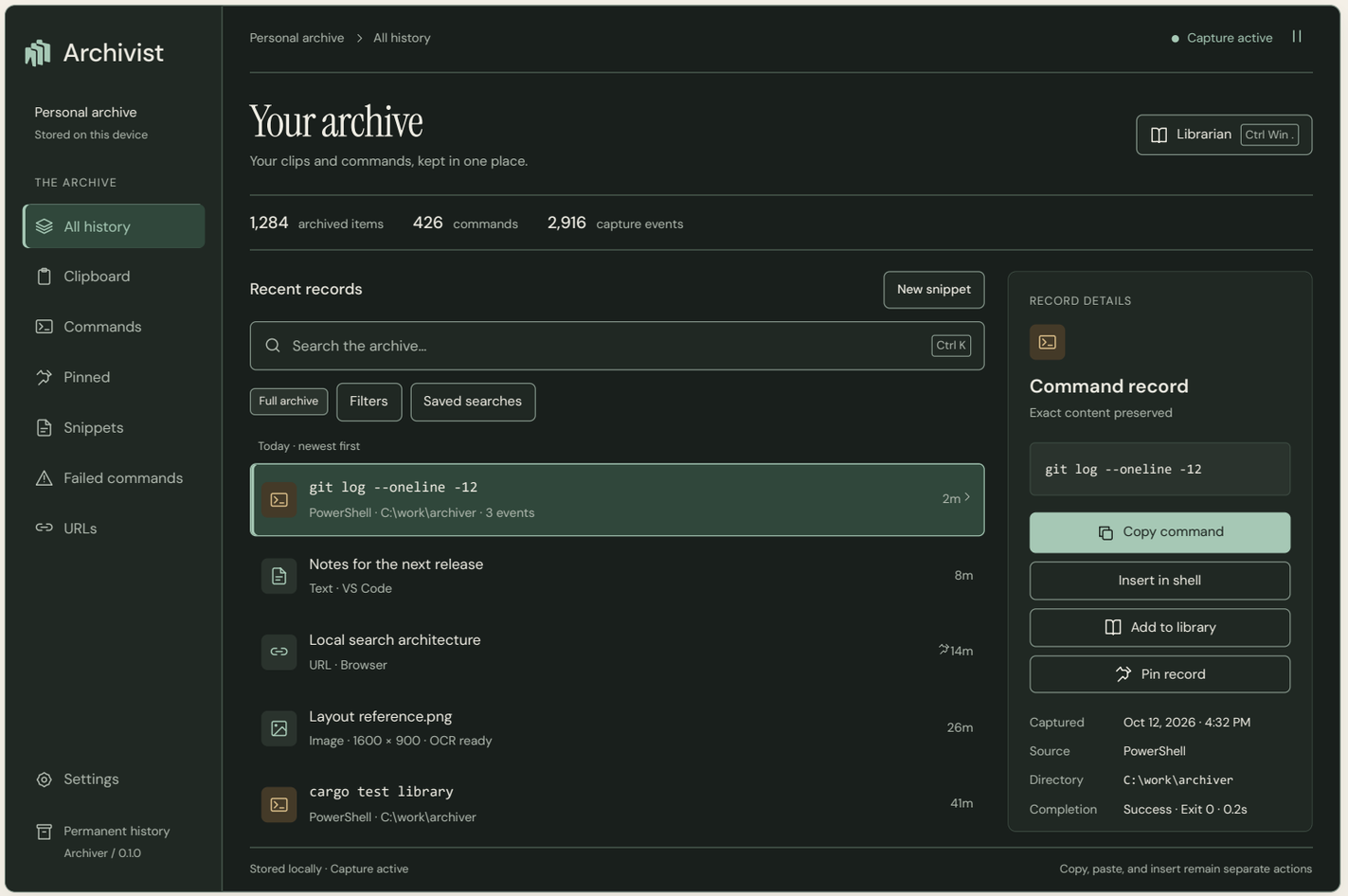


1280 × 850 frame shown at 72%. Counts, content, and metadata are sample data.

Dark mode should feel like the same place

Deep green-black surfaces replace midnight blue. Selection, typography, and geometry stay consistent.





Readable metadata, without faded gray

Solid, legible surfaces without glow or blur

State labels remain visible in both themes

Theme preference persists through the existing archiver-theme setting.

A common language for every tool

Record selection

Project notes

Text · editor · 8m ago

`npm run build`

Command · PowerShell · 2m ago

Use an inset leading rule and background. Focus gets a separate 2 px ring. Hover uses raised paper.

Actions and scope

Copy command | Add to library

Library | Archive | Pinned

One filled primary per action group. Explicit verbs distinguish copy, paste, insert, and deletion.

Capture and shell states

- Capture active
- Capture paused
- Capture interrupted
- PowerShell connected

Use the actual reported state. Unknown health stays unknown. Color never carries the message alone.

Dialogs and supporting tools

Transform and copy

Trim whitespace — Enter

Format JSON

Original content stays archived.

The same treatment extends to snippets, filters, queues, OCR, diffs, import, backup, and settings.

Destructive controls use text and a danger icon. Keep existing confirmations and recovery rules. Clearing the library must explicitly say it keeps archive history.

The theme lives in the details

Write like a helpful keeper of records

Current space language	Proposed language
Nothing lost in space.	Your archive
The recent orbit	Recent records
In your orbit.	Archive settings
No matches in this orbit	No matching records
Meaningful moments	Capture events

Empty library

Your library is clear
Your history is still in the archive. Include archive results to find it here.

Explicit deletion

Delete from archive
Retain current confirmation and recovery behavior. Do not imply that clearing the library deletes records.

Motifs

Small catalog tabs, inset selection rules, and fine section dividers create an archival rhythm. Content feels organized without mimicking a physical filing cabinet.

Motion

100 ms color changes for hover and selection. Up to 140 ms opacity with 4 px vertical travel for the quick panel. Focus immediately. No staggered rows or repeating ambient animation.

Accessibility and density

Body text targets at least 4.5:1 contrast. Focus, control boundaries, and selected edges target at least 3:1. Use text plus icons for state. Keep scrollbars discoverable, focus visible, and reduced motion immediate.

At smaller sizes

Keep Librarian search and footer visible; scroll results locally. At 900 × 400, Archivist reduces decorative heading space and keeps reachable details/actions. At 125–200% scaling, essential actions cannot rely on hover.

Use actual content as the hero

Do not introduce fake accession numbers, people, room illustrations, or decorative shelf rows in working surfaces.

A migration an agent can execute

Start with the supplied implementation brief. Apply this study to the existing UI and verify both windows before expanding scope.

01 **Establish the theme contract**

Map tokens.css into src/style.css. Preserve theme preference and cover all hardcoded surfaces, syntax colors, focus states, and dialogs.

02 **Replace identity and copy**

Remove Orbit marks, ring artwork, and space copy in src/main.tsx. Adopt catalog mark, window signatures, and clear library/archive language.

03 **Restyle the two windows**

Preserve 480 × 720 quick geometry and current shortcuts. Make Archivist results and details the visual priority.

04 **Carry the system through every tool**

Search, snippets, queues, timelines, OCR, diffs, settings, lifecycle, and command palette must use the same tokens.

05 **Validate and align documentation**

Frontend build and relevant UI checks. Rust checks only for Rust changes. Align feature catalog, STATUS, and ROADMAP with actual completion.

Nonnegotiable behavior

Preserve permanent archive history. Clearing the library changes visibility. Captures restore membership; command retries do not. Commands insert without execution.

Keep Ctrl+R shell search deferred. Experimental shell support and Windows-only OCR stay clearly labeled. New visuals do not imply new capabilities.

Release discipline

Generate icon assets for review, including monochrome tray output. Do not build or replace installers for this theme work.

Files for the implementation agent

IMPLEMENTATION.md
tokens.css
Primary SVG mark
Micro SVG mark
Creative asset provenance

HANDOFF.md retains the feature queue: undo library clearing and OCR match previews first, then five extensions. This study does not reorder it or mark planned work complete.